10th Class English • Unit 6 • Punjab Board (New Syllabus 2026)

Drug Abuse

Fully solved exercises: comprehension, MCQs, glossary, conjunctions and transitional devices, dialogue on drug prevention, informative writing

A. The Essay at a Glance

Type: an informative / explanatory essay. **Tone:** serious, objective and concerned, ending with a call for joint action. **Organisation:** definition → causes → effects → prevention and treatment → conclusion (problem-solution pattern).

Central idea: drug abuse is the harmful or wrong use of drugs that damages a person's health, behaviour and life; it destroys families and society, especially the youth, but it can be defeated if the government, schools, families, media and individuals work together.

Part of the essay	What it says
Definition	Drug abuse = harmful or wrong use of drugs. It includes heroin, hashish, opium, ice, and even sleeping pills or painkillers taken without a doctor's advice.
Causes	Lack of awareness, curiosity, peer pressure, unemployment and stress, family problems, pressure at school, emotional pain and easy access to drugs.
Effects on health	Damage to the brain, heart, lungs and liver; serious diseases; death from overdose.
Effects on behaviour	Mood swings, depression, anger, confusion; loss of interest in studies and work.
Effects on family and society	Stress and sadness at home; crime, accidents and violence in the community; money wasted.
Prevention	Awareness campaigns by the government and media, strict law against dealers, counselling in schools, parental care, sports, arts and hobbies, and rehabilitation centres for those already addicted.
Conclusion	Everyone deserves a healthy and happy life; by keeping people away from drugs and supporting those who recover, we can build a better and safer Pakistan.

B. Reading Comprehension — Answer the following questions

1. What is drug abuse, and how does it affect individuals and society?

Drug abuse means the harmful or wrong use of drugs — illegal drugs such as heroin, hashish, opium and ice, and even sleeping pills or painkillers taken without a doctor's advice. The addict's body and mind become dependent on the drug and he finds it very hard to stop.

Effect on the individual: the brain, heart, lungs and liver are damaged, serious diseases appear, behaviour changes (mood swings, depression, anger, confusion), interest in studies and work is lost, and an overdose can kill.

Effect on society: the whole family lives in stress and sadness, money is wasted, and crime, accidents and violence increase in the community. Young people — the future of the country — are the worst sufferers, so the whole nation is weakened.

2. What are the common causes of drug abuse in Pakistan?

The essay gives several causes: **(i) lack of awareness** — young people do not know how dangerous drugs are; **(ii) curiosity** — trying once "just to see"; **(iii) peer pressure** from friends who already use drugs; **(iv) unemployment and stress** — hopelessness about the future; **(v) family problems and emotional pain**; **(vi) pressure at school**; and **(vii) easy access** to drugs because of weak checking. Poverty, illiteracy and bad company make these causes stronger.

3. How does drug abuse negatively impact a person's health and behaviour?

Health: drugs damage the brain, heart, lungs, liver and other organs; the addict suffers from serious diseases, his weight and strength fall, his sleep and appetite are disturbed, and a heavy dose can cause death by overdose. Injecting drugs with a shared needle also spreads diseases like hepatitis and HIV.

Behaviour: the addict becomes moody, angry, depressed and confused. He tells lies, hides money, loses interest in studies or work, quarrels with his family and friends, and may turn to stealing or violence to buy the next dose. In short, his body is destroyed first and his character afterwards.

4. Why is drug abuse considered dangerous especially among the youth?

It is most dangerous for the youth for four reasons. **First**, the young are the easiest to tempt: curiosity, the wish to be accepted by friends and the desire for adventure push them to try the first dose. **Second**, a young body and mind are still growing, so the damage to the brain and to health is deeper and quicker. **Third**, addiction arrives at the very age when a student is choosing his career, so studies, skills and dreams are lost at the start. **Fourth**, the youth are the future of the nation; if they are lost, the country loses its doctors, teachers and workers together. This is why the essay calls drug abuse a serious challenge for Pakistan's youth.

5. What role can the government play in controlling drug abuse?

The government can: **(i) enforce strict laws** against drug dealers and smugglers and punish them quickly; **(ii) control the borders and the supply** of drugs; **(iii) run awareness campaigns** on television, radio and social media, and include drug education in the school curriculum; **(iv) provide free rehabilitation centres** and counselling for addicts, and treat them as patients rather than criminals; **(v) create jobs and sports facilities** for the youth so that they have a purpose and an entertainment other than drugs; and **(vi) involve the media, mosques and local organisations** in the campaign.

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6. What role can families and schools play in preventing drug abuse?

Families: parents must give their children time, love and attention, listen to their problems instead of only scolding them, know their friends, keep medicines and money safely and set a personal example — a home where there is no smoking or drinking is the strongest protection.

Schools: teachers must teach the facts about drugs in easy words, invite doctors and counsellors for talks, arrange sports, art and hobby clubs so that energy finds a healthy outlet, watch for warning signs (falling marks, new friends, moodiness) and inform the parents early. Above all, a school should be a place where a student feels noticed; a lonely child is the easiest target of a drug seller.

7. What are some of the harmful effects of drug abuse?

They can be grouped under three heads. **Health:** damage to the brain, heart, lungs and liver, diseases, overdose and death. **Behaviour:** mood swings, depression, anger, confusion, laziness, lies, and loss of interest in study and work. **Family and society:** stress and sadness at home, wasted money, quarrels, broken families, and an increase in crime, accidents and violence. The addict loses his health, his education, his family's trust and finally his future.

8. What are rehabilitation centres, and how do they help the people suffering from drug addiction?

Rehabilitation centres are special hospitals or welfare centres where drug addicts are treated and helped to recover. They first give medical treatment to control the withdrawal symptoms, then provide counselling and therapy to find out why the person started drugs, and then teach him skills, discipline and healthy habits so that he can live without drugs. Families are also guided to support the patient. In short, a rehabilitation centre gives an addict what a jail cannot — a second chance.

C. Choose the Correct Option (MCQs) — solved with key

1. What is drug abuse?

unsafe medicine — harmful use of drugs
unhealthy habit — unnatural cure

Answer: harmful use of drugs — The essay defines drug abuse as the harmful or wrong use of drugs.

2. Which age group is most affected by drug abuse in Pakistan?

adults (young adults and the youth) — old citizens
infants — small kids

Answer: adults (young adults and the youth) — The essay repeatedly says that the youth and young adults are the main victims of drug abuse.

3. What is a major cause of drug addiction among youth?

parental carelessness — peer pressure
social media — bad company

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Answer: peer pressure — The essay names peer pressure and curiosity as the biggest causes among the young.

4. What harmful effect does drug abuse have on health?

weight gain
muscle amputation
brain damage
numbness

Answer: brain damage — Drugs damage the brain, heart, lungs and liver.

5. What is a place where drug addicts are treated?

police station
rehabilitation centre
hospitals
bus station

Answer: rehabilitation centre — A rehabilitation centre helps an addict to recover from addiction.

D. Glossary — Words and Meanings

Word	Meaning
addicted	unable to stop using something harmful, like drugs
attention	focus or careful listening and looking
awareness	knowing or understanding something
confusion	a state of not understanding what is happening or what to do
deserves	to be worthy of something, such as help or praise
destroys	completely damages or breaks something
escape	to get away from something bad or dangerous
harmful	causing damage or hurt
kindness	being nice, caring and helpful to others
protect	to keep someone or something safe from harm
rehabilitation	a process to help someone recover from addiction
suffer	to feel pain, sadness or discomfort
violence	physical force used to hurt or damage someone or something

Devices

Device	What it does	Examples
Conjunction	Connects words, phrases or clauses inside a sentence	and, but, or, so, because, although, while

Device	What it does	Examples
Transitional device	Connects sentences, paragraphs or sections smoothly, so the reader can follow the argument	therefore, however, in addition, for instance, as a result, in contrast, on the other hand
Subordinating conjunction	Joins a dependent clause (which cannot stand alone) to an independent clause; shows cause, time, condition, contrast or purpose	because, although, since, when, if, even though, while, as, unless, before, after, so that

A. How does the writer's use of conjunctions and transitional devices contribute to the clarity and persuasiveness of the essay's message on drug prevention? Explain with at least one example for each.

1. Conjunctions give clarity by joining cause with effect. The essay says, “Drugs damage the brain, the heart, the lungs and the liver, **so** the addict can die of an overdose.” Here the simple conjunction “so” makes the reason-and-result relation unmistakable; the reader does not have to work it out.

2. Subordinating conjunctions make the warning persuasive. In “**If** we start now, we can create lasting change,” the conditional “if” turns the reader into a partner of the writer: the cure is placed in our own hands, which persuades far better than a command.

3. Contrast devices make the choice look sharp. “**But** this problem can be solved if we work together” changes the tone from fear to hope at exactly the right moment, so the reader does not close the essay in despair.

4. Transitional devices carry the reader from one paragraph to the next. The essay numbers its effects with “First… Second… Third…” and adds “**Furthermore**” and “**In addition**” when a new point is added. The line “**As a result**, families and society suffer” shows the reader that he has moved from the individual to the community. Without these signposts, a topic with so many causes and effects would look like a heap of facts; with them, it reads like an argument.

Rule for your own writing: use conjunctions inside sentences and transitional devices between them; never begin every sentence with the same connector, and keep one main idea in each paragraph.

F. Oral Communication Skills — Dialogue Writing

What the model dialogue “The Future is Ours” teaches: the two students greet each other, one explains the topic in simple words, the other asks a real question that moves the talk forward, both give examples with SDG numbers, and they finish with a joint plan. Stage directions in brackets ([Excitedly], [Curiously]) show the tone of the speaker, exactly as a director's notes do.

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Model dialogue on the prevention of drugs

[A classroom after the morning assembly. Two students, HAMZA and AYESHA, are standing near the notice board, where a poster reads “Say No to Drugs”.]

HAMZA: [looking at the poster] Ayesha, do you think a poster can stop anyone from taking drugs?

AYESHA: [thoughtfully] A poster alone cannot, Hamza. But it starts the conversation, and a conversation is where prevention begins.

HAMZA: [seriously] My cousin's friend started with sleeping pills for his exams. Now he cannot sleep without them. He says he began just to stay awake one night.

AYESHA: [shocked] That is exactly how it begins — with something that looks harmless. That is why we must never take any medicine without a doctor's advice.

HAMZA: But what can we do as students? We are not the police.

AYESHA: [firmly] We can do three things. First, we can invite a doctor to give a talk in our assembly. Second, we can start a sports and hobby club, because an empty evening is a drug seller's best friend. Third, if we see a class-fellow changing — falling marks, new friends, no money — we can tell a teacher instead of laughing at him.

HAMZA: [nodding] The third one is the hardest and the most important.

AYESHA: [smiling] Then let us write it on the poster: “A friend who speaks is better than a friend who stays silent.”

HAMZA: [picking up a marker] Deal. And I will ask the headmaster for the assembly slot today.

[They start writing on the poster as the bell rings.]

G. Writing Skills — Informative and Explanatory Writing

Informative writing **examines and explains** a complex idea, presents facts clearly and logically, uses a suitable structure and transitions, avoids bias and emotional language, and often includes definitions, examples and analysis. The essay on drug abuse is a good model of it.

A. In what ways does the structure and content of the essay help convey complex ideas about drug abuse prevention clearly and effectively?

The essay follows the natural order of the reader's questions: **what is it → why does it happen → what harm does it do → what can be done**. This order is effective because each part answers the question that the previous part has created in the reader's mind. Its content is also well chosen: a clear definition in the first paragraph, a list of real causes (peer pressure, unemployment, lack of awareness), then effects arranged from the individual to the family and to society, and finally a section of practical solutions for the government, the schools, the families and the individual. The language is factual and unemotional — “causes”, “effects”, “should” — so the reader trusts it, and the short paragraphs make the information easy to remember. The conclusion repeats the main idea in one hopeful sentence, which leaves the reader with a lesson instead of a lecture.

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B. How does the organisation of ideas in the essay help the reader understand the complexity of the issue, and how could formatting or visuals enhance this understanding further?

The organisation moves like a ladder: the reader climbs from the **definition** to the **causes**, then to the **effects on health, behaviour and society**, and finally to the **solutions**. Each step rests on the step below, so the reader never meets an idea he is not prepared for. Words like “First… Second… Third…” and “Furthermore” mark each step clearly, and the pattern problem → solution keeps the essay from becoming a list of fears.

Formatting and visuals could improve it further: a **flow chart** of causes → effects, a **two-column table** of “Effects on the individual / Effects on society”, a **pie chart** of the age groups affected, and **subheadings** such as “Causes”, “Effects” and “Prevention” would let a reader find one piece of information in a second. A small **infographic** of the warning signs of addiction would be especially useful for young readers, because a picture is remembered longer than a paragraph.

C. In what ways does the writer use relevant facts, examples and explanations to develop the topic of drug abuse prevention, and how does this support the needs of the intended audience?

The writer **names the drugs** (heroin, hashish, opium, ice, sleeping pills, painkillers) so that the danger is not vague; he **lists the organs damaged** (brain, heart, lungs, liver) so that the health warning is concrete; he gives **social causes** that a young Pakistani reader recognises at once — peer pressure, unemployment, family problems, school pressure; and he **explains** each cause in a sentence or two instead of only naming it. For prevention he does not only say “be aware”: he tells exactly who should do what — the government should make strict laws and open rehabilitation centres, schools should run awareness programmes and sports, families should give time and attention, and the media should run campaigns.

This supports the intended audience — students, parents and teachers — because a student needs facts that he can repeat to a friend, a parent needs practical advice, and a teacher needs a clear message for an assembly. The facts make the essay believable, the examples make it personal, and the explanations make it usable.

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H. Summary of the Essay

Drug abuse means the harmful or wrong use of drugs, including heroin, hashish, opium, ice, and even sleeping pills or painkillers taken without a doctor's advice, and its victims increase every year. The main causes are lack of awareness, curiosity, peer pressure, unemployment, stress, family problems, school pressure, emotional pain and easy access to drugs. Its harmful effects fall on three levels: on health, damaging the brain, heart, lungs and liver and even causing death by overdose; on behaviour, causing mood swings, depression, anger and confusion and destroying interest in study and work; and on the family and society, where it brings sadness, wasted money, crime, accidents and violence. The youth are the worst sufferers, because curiosity and friends tempt them first and because the nation's future is lost with them. Prevention needs a joint effort: the government must make strict laws,

control the supply of drugs, run awareness campaigns and provide rehabilitation centres; schools must teach the facts, arrange counselling and promote sports and hobbies; families must give love, attention and good example; and the media must spread the message. The essay ends with hope: drug abuse can be defeated if everyone works together, because every person deserves a healthy and happy life.

Points to Remember

• Drug abuse = harmful or wrong use of drugs that damages health, behaviour and life.

• Drugs named in the essay: heroin, hashish, opium, ice, sleeping pills and painkillers without a doctor's advice.

• Causes: lack of awareness, curiosity, peer pressure, unemployment, stress, family problems, school pressure, easy access.

• Effects: brain, heart, lungs and liver damage; overdose death; mood swings, depression, anger, confusion; crime, accidents, violence, family breakdown.

• Prevention: strict laws, border control, awareness campaigns, counselling, sports and hobbies, parental care, media, rehabilitation centres.

• Rehabilitation centre = a place where addicts are medically treated, counselled and taught healthy habits.

• Conjunctions (and, but, so, because) join inside sentences; transitional devices (therefore, however, in addition, as a result) join sentences and paragraphs; subordinating conjunctions (because, although, if, since, unless) join a dependent clause to a main clause.

• Informative writing: clear definition, logical order, facts and examples, no emotional bias, headings and transitions.